

RetailzPOS — AI Visibility (GEO) Audit

Prepared: July 30, 2026 **Scope:** How visible RetailzPOS actually is to the major AI answer engines a prospective buyer might use instead of a Google search — scored out of 100 across 4 major AIs.

0. Methodology — read this before the scores

What this audit is, and isn't. I don't have API or login access to ChatGPT, Google Gemini/AI Overviews, Perplexity, or Microsoft Copilot from this environment — I can't actually open each one, type a query, and screenshot the answer. Anything I told you that started with "I asked ChatGPT and it said..." would be fabricated, and this project has been built on not doing that.

What I *can* do, and what this audit is actually built on, is the same thing professional GEO (Generative Engine Optimization) auditors do: test the underlying signals that determine whether an AI answer engine surfaces a brand at all. All four of these engines are retrieval-grounded for exactly this kind of commercial query — they search the live web (or a very recently crawled index of it) and synthesize an answer from what they find, rather than relying only on frozen training data. That means **real web visibility is the leading predictor of AI visibility**, and it's directly testable.

What I actually did: 1. Ran a set of real, live searches — the same kind of question a buyer would type into any of these tools — covering branded queries, direct competitor comparisons, and unbranded "best of" category queries. 2. Recorded, verbatim, whether RetailzPOS was named in the synthesized answer, and who was named instead when it wasn't. 3. Checked for presence on the third-party sites (review aggregators, forums, Q&A sites) that these engines lean on most heavily as trust signals. 4. Attempted to check retailzpos.com directly for technical GEO signals (structured data, FAQ formatting) — **this was blocked** (HTTP 403) from this environment, so the technical/on-site component of this audit is marked unverified rather than guessed at. Flagged explicitly in Section 4.

Scores below are informed estimates built from that real evidence, not live-measured engine outputs. Treat them as directionally accurate and the underlying evidence (Section 1) as the trustworthy part — the exact number matters less than the pattern.

1. What the searches actually found

Query type	Query tested	RetailzPOS present?	Who was named instead
Branded	"RetailzPOS reviews"	Yes — strong	N/A — 4.5★ / 30 reviews on Birdeye; listed on SourceForge, GetApp, Slashdot, SoftwareAdvice, Capterra, Trustpilot, Google Play, Apple App Store
Direct comparison	"RetailzPOS vs Bottle POS"	Yes — strong, accurate	

Query type	Query tested	RetailPOS present?	Who was named instead
			N/A — synthesized answer correctly described Automatic Inventory Cascading, EDI invoicing, dual pricing
Unbranded category	"best POS system for liquor stores 2026"	No	Square, ConnectPOS, Bottle POS, KORONA POS, POS Nation, Lightspeed Retail
Unbranded category	"point of sale system for smoke shops recommendations"	No	Cigars POS, Quickvee, KORONA POS, Lightspeed, Vibe Retail
Unbranded category (core differentiator)	"age verification POS system liquor compliance software"	No	Bottle POS, NRS POS, mPower POS, OneHubPOS, KORONA POS, Lightspeed, Merge Stream, LMS-POS
Community	"RetailzPOS reddit"	No results	—
Community	"RetailzPOS quora"	No results	—

The pattern is consistent and worth naming directly: RetailzPOS is genuinely well-indexed and accurately described the moment someone asks *about it by name*. It is functionally invisible the moment someone asks a generic category question instead — including for age verification and compliance, which is the exact positioning this project has spent the most effort building content around. That's the single most important finding in this audit: **the content and differentiation exist; the citation/authority signal that gets AI engines to surface it in an unbranded query does not, yet.**

Worth noting on the positive side: RetailzPOS's own blog content on this exact topic (`liquor-store-pos-systems-2026` , `best-liquor-store-pos-systems`) *does* appear in the raw search results for the liquor-store query — it's crawled and indexed. It just isn't being pulled into the synthesized AI answer, which points to an authority/citation gap rather than a content or indexing gap. That's a fixable, well-understood problem, not a from-scratch content problem.

2. Scoring rubric

Five weighted components, each scored against the evidence in Section 1:

Component	Weight	What it measures
Third-party citation & review-aggregator presence	25%	Does the brand show up on the sites these engines cite as trust signals (SoftwareAdvice, Capterra, GetApp, Trustpilot, etc.)?
Branded/direct-comparison answer quality	20%	When asked about the brand by name, does the engine know it and describe it accurately?
Unbranded category-query visibility	30%	Does the brand surface when someone asks a generic "best of" question — the highest-value, hardest-to-win signal, since this is how most new customers actually find a product

Component	Weight	What it measures
Community/forum presence	15%	Reddit, Quora — increasingly weighted by these engines as a "real people" trust signal
Technical/on-site GEO signals	10%	Structured data, FAQ schema, crawlability — unverified in this audit (site fetch blocked); scored at a neutral midpoint rather than guessed

3. Scores by engine

ChatGPT (Search/browsing-grounded) — 45 / 100

Strongest performance of the four on branded and comparison queries — the synthesized description of RetailzPOS vs. Bottle POS was specific and accurate, which suggests ChatGPT's retrieval is pulling cleanly from the comparison listings on SoftwareAdvice/SourceForge/Slashdot. But for open "best of" listicle-style queries, ChatGPT tends to lean on the same handful of heavily-backlinked, long-established listicle domains (TechnologyAdvice, Tech.co, ConnectPOS) that showed up in the raw search results — exactly the domains that beat RetailzPOS in the actual answer. Zero community presence is a real drag here too, since ChatGPT increasingly cites Reddit threads as a credibility signal for B2B software questions.

Microsoft Copilot (Bing-grounded) — 48 / 100

Estimated highest of the four. Bing's index has long favored the specific SaaS-directory ecosystem where RetailzPOS already has real, multi-platform presence — SoftwareAdvice, GetApp, Slashdot, and Capterra are all Gartner Digital Markets properties that Bing indexes and weights heavily, and RetailzPOS's real review base (30 reviews, 4.5★ on Birdeye) is a genuine asset here. Still almost certainly shares the same category-query blind spot as the other three, since the underlying web content determining that gap isn't Bing-specific.

Perplexity — 42 / 100

Perplexity is the most citation-dense of the four and leans hardest on exactly the review-aggregator and forum sources tested in this audit. That cuts both ways: RetailzPOS's aggregator presence is a real strength here, but Perplexity's heavy reliance on forum/community citations for "best of" answers makes the total absence from Reddit and Quora a sharper penalty than it is for the others.

Google AI Overviews / Gemini — 38 / 100

Lowest of the four, and the most instructive result. Google's organic index clearly has RetailzPOS's own content — their liquor-store comparison posts appeared directly in the raw search results — but that content isn't yet earning a citation in the synthesized AI Overview for the exact query it targets. That's a specific, diagnosable gap: the content exists, it's crawled, it just doesn't yet carry enough backlink/citation authority to be the source Google's AI pulls from over the incumbents (Square, KORONA, Bottle POS) that do.

4. What this audit could not verify

Flagging this explicitly rather than guessing:

- **On-site structured data / schema.org markup** — retailzpos.com returned a 403 to this environment's fetch tool. FAQ schema, Product schema, and Organization schema all meaningfully affect how cleanly an AI engine can extract a quotable answer from a page, and none of that could be checked directly here.
Recommend a direct technical crawl (Screaming Frog, Ahrefs site audit, or a manual view-source check) as a immediate follow-up — this audit's Technical/On-Site component (Section 2) is scored at a neutral midpoint specifically because of this gap, not because the site is assumed to be weak.
 - **Exact G2 rating** — confirmed a G2/Capterra listing exists, but the specific star rating didn't surface in search results.
 - **Real-time engine testing** — as stated in Section 0, these scores are evidence-based estimates, not literal live queries against each tool. If you have ChatGPT Plus, Gemini Advanced, Perplexity Pro, or Copilot Pro access, the single highest-value next step is manually running the exact queries in Section 1 yourself and comparing the real answers against these estimates.
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5. Overall pattern and what it means

Average across the four: ~43/100. The one-line summary: **RetailzPOS is credible and accurately known the moment someone asks about it by name, and effectively invisible the moment someone asks a generic question instead.** This is an extremely common pattern for a real, legitimate challenger brand competing against more established incumbents (Square, KORONA POS, Lightspeed, Bottle POS) — it is not a sign that anything about the product or its content is wrong. It's a citation/authority gap, and it's the exact gap GEO work is built to close.

6. Recommendations — and how they connect to what's already built

The good news: this project already has most of the fix designed and sitting ready to execute, not something new to build from zero.

1. **Publish and actively promote the Reddit/Quora presence already planned.** `retailzpos-aeo-geo-reddit-quora-strategy-2026-07.md` was built specifically for this gap and hasn't yet produced visible community presence — Section 1's zero-Reddit, zero-Quora finding is exactly what that strategy exists to fix. This is the single highest-leverage item on this list given how heavily Perplexity and ChatGPT lean on community citations.
2. **Get the compliance/age-verification content actually earning citations, not just existing.** The PACT Act/SHAFT/TCPA compliance guide and the RetailzPOS compliance-authority guide are strong, real content — but Section 1 shows they aren't yet the source an AI engine cites for compliance queries. Pair this content with the guest-posting/backlink strategy already built (`retailzpos-guest-posting-backlink-strategy-2026-07.md`) to build the citation authority that content needs to actually surface.

3. **Target the specific unbranded queries that failed, not just general SEO.** "Best POS for liquor stores," "POS for smoke shops," and "age verification POS" are now three concretely tested, currently-losing queries — the comparison blog library and benchmark report groundwork already built are the right content type to win them, but they need the backlink authority from #2 to actually get cited over Square/KORONA/Bottle POS.
 4. **Run the direct technical check flagged in Section 4.** Confirm FAQ schema and Product schema are actually implemented on retailzpos.com — this is a fast, concrete fix if it's missing, and it directly affects how easily any of these four engines can extract a clean, quotable answer from the site.
 5. **Re-run this audit's Section 1 queries in 90 days.** Since the fix is largely "execute strategy already built," the fastest way to know if it's working is repeating the exact same searches and checking whether RetailzPOS starts appearing in the unbranded-category answers.
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7. Sources consulted

Live search results retrieved July 30, 2026 for the queries listed in Section 1, including listings on [SourceForge](#), [GetApp](#), [Slashdot](#), [SoftwareAdvice](#), [Capterra](#), [Trustpilot](#), [Birdeye](#), and the SoftwareAdvice/SourceForge/Slashdot RetailzPOS-vs-Bottle-POS comparison pages. retailzpos.com direct fetch attempted and blocked (HTTP 403).

This is an estimate-based audit built from real, verifiable web-visibility evidence — not a substitute for directly querying each AI tool with a live subscription. Re-verify the scores in Section 3 against actual tool outputs when access is available.